SONG OF SOLOMON

Conversational Version

1:1 Solomon's Song of Songs

Bride

2 *"Please kiss me! Your love is better than wine.*
3 *Your anointing oils have a pleasing fragrance;*
your name is like purified oil;
that's why young women love you.
4 *Take me with you; let's hurry off together!*
The king will take me to his rooms.

Friends

"We'll celebrate with you and be happy;
we'll praise your love more than wine.
they're right in loving you. **S of S 1:1-4**

Bride

5 *"I'm black, but beautiful, young women of Jerusalem,*
like the tents of Kedar, like the curtains of Solomon.
6 *Don't stare at me because I'm dark,*
because the sun has darkened my skin.
My mother's sons were mad at me;
they made me take care of vineyards,
I've neglected my own vineyard.
7 *You that I love, tell me*
where you pasture your flock,
where you have them lie down at noon."

Groom

8 *"If you don't know, most beautiful woman,*
follow the flock's tracks,
and pasture your young goats by the shepherds' tents.
S of S 1:5-8
9 *"My darling, to me you're like my mare among Pharaoh's chariots.*
10 *Your cheeks are lovely with earrings,*
and your neck pretty with strings of beads."

Friends

11 *"We'll make you gold earrings with silver beads."*

Bride

12 *"While the king was on his couch,*

my perfume floated out its scent.
13 *My beloved is to me a pouch of myrrh*
that lies all night between my breasts.
14 *My beloved is to me a cluster of henna blossoms*
in the vineyards of En-gedi." **S of S 1:9-14**

Groom

15 *"My darling, you're so beautiful!*
You're so lovely!
Your eyes are like doves."

Bride

16 *"How handsome you are, my beloved, and so pleasant!*
Our couch is luxurious!
17 *The beams in our houses are cedar;*
our rafters are fir." **S of S 1:15-17**

2:1 *"I'm a rose of Sharon, a lily of the valley."*

Groom

2 *"My darling among young women is*
like a lily among thorns."

Bride

3 *"My beloved among young men is*
like an apricot tree in the forest.
I took great delight in its shade and sat down,
and its fruit tasted sweet.
4 *He has taken me to his banquet hall,*
and love is his banner above me.
5 *Sustain me with raisin cakes,*
refresh me with apples, because I'm lovesick.
6 *Let his left hand be under my head,*
and his right hand embrace me." **S of S 2:1-6**

Groom

7 *"I want you to swear, young women of Jerusalem,*
by the gazelles or hinds in the field,
that you won't wake up my love till she's ready."

Bride

8 *"Listen! My beloved! Look, he's coming,*
jumping across the mountains, leaping over the hills!
9 *My beloved is like a gazelle or a young stag.*
It's standing behind our wall;

looking in the windows;
staring through the lattice. **S of S 2:7-9**

10 *"My beloved answered me,*
'Get up, my darling, my beautiful one,
and come along.
11 *Winter's over; the rains have come and gone.*
12 *Flowers are coming out;*
it's time to sing;
we can hear the turtledove.
13 *Fig trees have ripened their figs;*
vines in blossom are giving off their scent.
Get up, my darling, my beautiful one,
and come along with me!
14 *My dove, in the cleft of the rock,*
in the secret place by the steep path,
let me see you; let me hear you;
because your singing is sweet,
your looks are lovely.' **S of S 2:10-14**

15 *"Catch the foxes for us,*
the little foxes that are ruining the vineyards
that are in bloom.
16 *My beloved's mine, and I'm his;*
he pastures his flock among the lilies.
17 *Till the evening breeze comes and shadows recede,*
turn, my beloved, and be like a gazelle
or a young stag on the mountains." **S of S 2:15-17**

Bride

3:1 *"In bed night after night I sought the one I love;*
I looked for him but didn't find him.
2 *'I need to get up and look around the city;*
in the streets and squares
I have to find the one I love.'
I looked for him, but I didn't find him.
3 *The watchmen that make their rounds in the city met me;* I said,
'Have you seen the one I love?'
4 *I had just left them when I found him.*
I held onto him and wouldn't let him go,

till I'd brought him to my mother's house,
to the room where she conceived me." **S of S 3:1-4**

Groom

5 *"I want you to swear, young women of Jerusalem,*
by the gazelles or hinds in the field,
that you won't wake up my love till she's ready."

Friends

6 *"What's this coming up from the countryside*
like columns of smoke,
perfumed with myrrh and frankincense,
with all the merchant's scented powders?
7 *It's Solomon's portable couch,*
with 60 of Israel's strong men around it.
8 *All of them are swordsmen, expert in war;*
each with his sword at his side,
guarding against the dangers at night.
9 *King Solomon has made an enclosed portable chair*
from wood in Lebanon.
10 *He made its posts out of silver,*
its back out of gold,
its seat out of purple fabric,
and its interior lovingly fitted out
by the young women of Jerusalem.
11 *Go out, young women of Zion,*
and look at King Solomon,
wearing the crown his mother gave him
on his wedding day, his happy day." **S of S 3:5-11**

Groom

4:1 *"You are so beautiful, my darling;*
you're so beautiful!
Your eyes are like doves behind your veil;
your hair is like a flock of goats
coming down Mount Gilead.
2 *Your teeth are like a flock of shorn ewes*
that have come up from their washing,
that have all had twins
and none have miscarried.
3 *Your lips are like a scarlet thread;*
your mouth is lovely;

your cheeks are like the halves of a pomegranate
behind your veil.
4 *Your neck is like the tower of David,*
built with rows of stones
that have 1,000 shields hanging on them,
the round shields of strong men. **S of S 4:1-4**
5 *Your two breasts are like two fawns,*
twins of a gazelle,
that feed among the lilies.
6 *Till the evening breeze comes and shadows recede,*
I'll go my way to the mountain of myrrh
and the hill of frankincense.

7 *"You're so beautiful, my darling;*
there's not a blemish on you.
8 *Come with me from Lebanon, my bride;*
leave the summit of Amana,
the top of Senir and Hermon,
away from the lions' dens,
the mountains and their leopards. **S of S 4:5-8**
9 *You've made my heart beat faster,* ***my sister, my bride****;*
you've made it beat faster
with a single glance with your eyes,
with one jewel of your necklace.
10 *Your love is so sweet,* ***my sister, my bride****!*
so much better than wine;
the fragrance of your oils
is more pleasing than any spice!
11 *Your lips, my bride, distil nectar;*
honey and milk are under your tongue;
the fragrance of your clothes is like the fragrance of Lebanon.
12 *A garden locked is* ***my sister, my bride****,*
a garden locked, a fountain sealed. **S of S 4:9-12**
13 *Your sprouts are an orchard of pomegranates*
with choice fruits, henna with nard,
14 *nard and saffron, calamus and cinnamon,*
with all the trees of frankincense,
myrrh and aloes, along with the finest spices.

15 *You're a garden spring,*
a well of fresh water,
a stream flowing from Lebanon." **S of S 4:13-15**

Bride

16 *"Wake up, north wind;*
come, wind from the south;
make my garden breathe out fragrance;
let its spices carry abroad;
let my beloved go to his garden,
and eat its best produce!" **S of S 4:16**

Groom

5:1 *"I've come to my garden,* ***my sister, my bride****;*
I've gathered my myrrh and spice.
I've eaten my honey and honeycomb,
and drunk my wine and milk.
Eat, friends, and drink;
drink deeply, lovers." **S of S 5:1**

Bride

2 *"I was asleep, but my heart was awake.*
A voice! my beloved is knocking.
'Open for me, ***my sister, my darling****,*
my dove, my perfect one!
My head is drenched with dew;
my hair is damp from the night.'
3 *I've taken off my dress;*
how can I put it on again?
I've washed my feet;
how can I get them dirty again?
4 *My beloved extended his hand through the opening,*
my feelings were aroused. **S of S 5:2-4**
5 *I got up to open the door for him;*
my hands dripped with myrrh,
my fingers with liquid myrrh,
on the handles of the bolt.
6 *I opened for my beloved,*
but he'd turned away and gone!
I looked for him but didn't find him;
I called for him, but he didn't answer.
7 *The watchmen that make their rounds in the city met me;*

they struck me and hurt me;
the guardsmen took my shawl.
8 *I adjure you, young women of Jerusalem,*
if you find my beloved, tell him I'm lovesick." **S of S 5:5-8**

Friends

9 *"But what kind of beloved is he,*
most beautiful among women?
What kind of beloved is your beloved,
that you adjure us that way?" **S of S 5:9**

Bride

10 *"My beloved is radiant and healthy,*
outstanding among 10,000.
11 *His head is like gold—pure gold;*
his hair is like clusters of dates,
and black as a raven.
12 *His eyes are like doves beside streams of water,*
bathed in milk and neatly set.
13 *His cheeks are like a bed of spices,*
banks of sweet-scented herbs;
his lips are lilies,
dripping with liquid myrrh.
14 *His hands are rods of gold,*
set with beryl;
his abdomen is carved ivory
inlaid with lapis lazuli.
15 *His legs are alabaster pillars*
set on pedestals of pure gold;
his appearance is like Lebanon,
as choice as the cedars.
16 *His mouth is full of sweetness;*
he's so desirable.
That's my beloved, my friend,
young women of Jerusalem." **S of S 5:10-16**

Friends

6:1 *"Where has your beloved gone,*
most beautiful among women?
Where has he turned
so we can help you find him?"

Bride

2 *"He's gone down to his garden, to the beds of spices,*
to pasture his flock in the gardens and gather lilies.
3 *I'm my beloved's, and my beloved's mine,*
the one that pastures his flock among the lilies." **S of S 6:1-3**

Groom

4 *"You're as beautiful as Tirzah, my darling,*
as lovely as Jerusalem,
as awesome as an army with standards.
5 *Turn your eyes away from me;*
they overpower me;
your hair is like a flock of goats
coming down from Gilead.
6 *Your teeth are like a flock of ewes,*
that have come up from their washing,
that have all had twins
and none have miscarried.
7 *Your cheeks are like the halves of a pomegranate*
behind your veil.
8 *There are 60 queens and 80 concubines,*
and young women without number.
9 *But my dove, my perfect one, is unique;*
her mother's only daughter,
the pure child of the one that bore her. **S of S 6:4-9**

10 *"Who is this that grows like the dawn,*
as beautiful as the full moon,
as pure as the sun,
as awesome as an army with standards?
11 *I went down to the orchard of nut trees*
to see the blossoms in the valley,
to see if the grapevines had budded,
or the pomegranates had bloomed.
12 *Before I knew it, my fancy put me*
in a chariot over my noble people."

Friends

13 *"Come back, Shulammite;*
Come back so we can get a good look at you!

14 *"Why should you gaze at the Shulammite,*

as at the jostling between two armies?" **S of S 6:10-14**

Groom

7:1 *"Your feet are so graceful in sandals,*
prince's daughter!
The curves of your hips are like jewels,
the work of an artist's hand.
2 *Your navel is like a round goblet*
that's always full of mixed wine;
your stomach is like a pile of wheat
encircled by lilies.
3 *Your two breasts are like two fawns,*
twins of a gazelle.
4 *Your neck is like an ivory tower;*
your eyes are like the pools of Heshbon
by the gate of Bath-rabbim;
your nose is like the tower of Lebanon,
that overlooks Damascus. **S of S 7:1-4**
5 *Your head crowns you like Carmel,*
and the flowing locks of your hair are like purple threads;
the king is captivated by your tresses.
6 *How beautiful and delightful you are,*
my love, with all your charms!
7 *You're stately like a date palm;*
your breasts are like its clusters.
8 *I said, 'I'll climb the palm tree*
and take hold of its fruit.'
May your breasts be like clusters on a vine;
your breath is fragrant like apples;
9 *Your mouth is like the best wine!"* **S of S 7:5-9a**

Bride

"It goes down smoothly for my beloved,
and flows gently through the lips of people getting sleepy.

10 *"I'm my beloved's,*
and his desire is for me.
11 *Come on, my beloved, let's go out in the country,*
and spend the night in the villages.
12 *Let's get up early and visit the vineyards*

to see if the grapevines have budded,
if their blossoms are opening,
if the pomegranates have bloomed.
Then I'll give you my love.
13 *The mandrakes have given off their fragrance;*
above our doors are choice fruits, new and old,
that I've saved up for you, my beloved. **S of S 7:9b-13**

8:1 *"Oh that you were my brother,*
who nursed at my mother's breasts.
If I found you outdoors, I'd kiss you;
and nobody would despise me.
2 *I'd take you into my mother's house,*
who used to instruct me;
I'd give you wine spiced from my pomegranates.
3 *Let his left hand be under my head,*
and his right hand embrace me."

Groom

4 *"I want you to swear, young women of Jerusalem;*
that you won't wake up my beloved till she's ready."

Friends

5 *"Who's that coming up from the countryside,*
leaning on her beloved?" **S of S 8:1-5a**

Groom

"Under the apple tree I woke you up;
that's where your mother was in labor with you,
and gave birth.
6 *Put me like a seal over your heart,*
like a seal on your arm.
Love is as strong as death;
jealousy is as cruel as Sheol;
It flashes fire,
a very vehement flame.
7 *Flood water can't quench love;*
a river won't drown it;
If a man would offer all the wealth in his house for love,
it would be utterly scorned." **S of S 8:5b-7**

Friends

8 *"We have a little sister,*
and she doesn't have breasts;

what will we do for her
when she's spoken for?
9 *If she's a wall,*
we'll build a silver battlement on her;
but if she's a door,
we'll barricade her in with cedar boards." **S of S 8:8-9**

Bride

10 *"I was a wall, and my breasts became like towers;*
then I was in his eyes like a person that brings peace.
11 *Solomon had a vineyard at Baal-hamon;*
he entrusted it to caretakers;
each one was to bring 25 lbs [1,000 shekels] of silver for its fruit.
12 *My own vineyard is at my disposal;*
the 25 lbs [1,000 shekels] of silver are for you, Solomon,
and 5 lbs [200 shekels] are for the ones that take care of its fruit."

Groom

13 *"You that sit in the gardens,*
my companions are listening for your voice—
let me hear it!"

Bride

14 *"Hurry, my beloved;*
be like a gazelle or young stag
on the mountains of spices." **S of S 8:10-14**

Version by Virgil Warren: christir.org